
Subject: Epidemiological Report for Respiratory Illnesses

Date: 09 April 2026

Introduction

This report provides a summary of the available epidemiological data on the spread of influenza, COVID-19 (coronavirus) and RSV (Respiratory Syncytial Virus) activity in Jersey. This is the final epidemiological report for the 2025/26 winter season, monthly reporting has now been stepped down until autumn 2026.

The report includes the number of influenza-like illness cases, positive influenza cases (flu A & B), and positive RSV cases in Jersey to date this season, with comparisons to historic seasons.

The report also includes information on COVID-19 PCR testing rates and the number of positive COVID-19 cases over the last 12 months. De-escalation of elements of COVID-19 testing and reporting from the end of January 2023 have affected the COVID-19 surveillance data available, and information should be interpreted with this in mind.

The positive case data in this report currently includes PCR results only. Another type of test (4-in-1 lateral flow tests, LFTs) are now used alongside PCRs to diagnose influenza, COVID-19, and RSV. This LFT data will be incorporated into future releases once quality assured. This change in testing practice may result in a slight reduction in reported positive cases and overall testing numbers across COVID-19, influenza, and RSV, as PCRs are no longer the only diagnostic test available.

Key Points

Influenza

Flu-like illness activity has decreased in Jersey but remains within the normal activity levels for this time of year (Figure 1). The total confirmed influenza A and B positives for the season-to-date is 38, lower compared to the previous 3 seasons (Table 1).

In comparison, the most recent data shows that influenza was circulating at baseline levels in England. Confirmed influenza cases have declined in England following an earlier than usual increase in influenza activity this season.¹

RSV

The total confirmed positive RSV cases this season to date is 26 (Table 2). This season-to-date cumulative number is lower than in the previous 4 years.

The most recent data for England shows that RSV is circulating at baseline levels, and swab positivity rate decreasing to 1%.¹

COVID-19

The number of PCR tests carried out in Jersey in the most recent month was around 20 (Figure 2). The number of monthly positive COVID-19 PCR tests in March 2026 was <5 (Figure 3).

In comparison, the most recent data for England shows that COVID-19 activity has remained stable and is circulating at baseline levels.¹

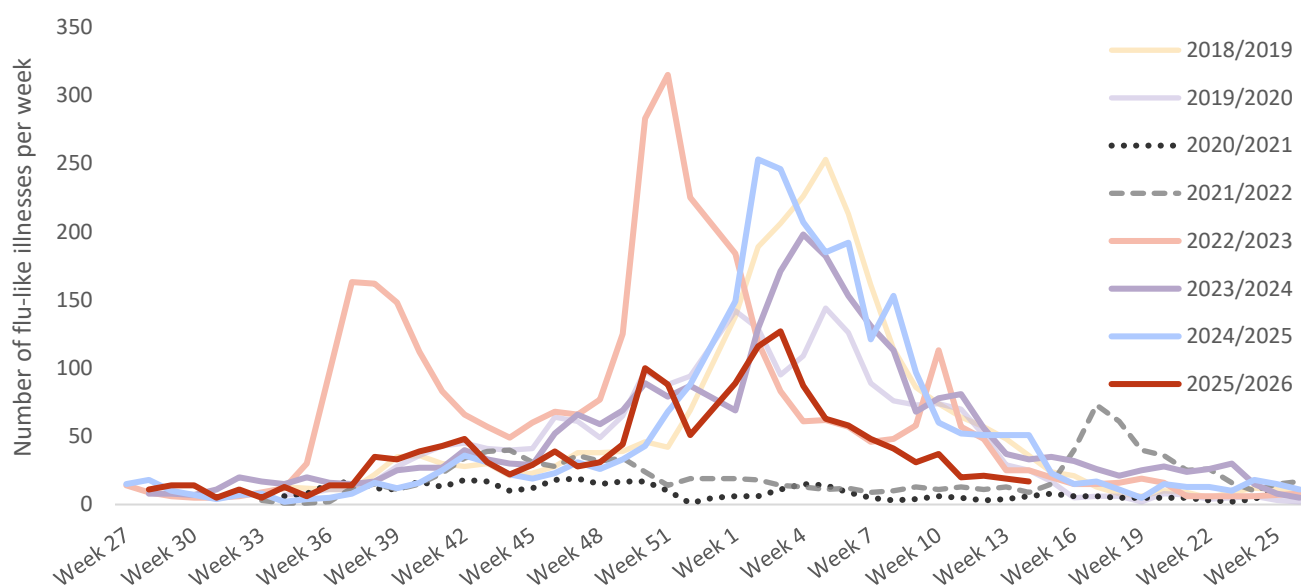
¹ [National Influenza and COVID-19 surveillance report - 2025-2026 season](#)

Numbers of 'flu-like' illnesses presenting to GPs

Figure 1 shows the numbers recorded per week presenting to their GP with 'flu-like' symptoms over each flu season between 2018/2019 and 2025/2026. Each flu season is measured from the beginning of July (week 27) to the end of June the following year (week 26).

The individual flu-season profiles vary, in terms of the peak number of cases seen, the timing of the increase and decrease in the number of cases, and shape of profile. At present, flu-like illness is within the low to normal range for this point in the season. For further analysis of historic flu seasons please see the [Influenza and Winter Illness Report](#).

Figure 1: Weekly flu like-illness across influenza seasons, 2018/2019 to 2025/2026



Patients with confirmed Influenza and RSV

The cumulative number of confirmed positive cases of Flu A & B and RSV for the season so far (i.e. up to week 14 2026) are shown in Tables 1 and 2.

Note that the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic has affected influenza testing protocols, due to the need to clinically distinguish between the different respiratory illnesses. This means comparisons of years before and after the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic should be done with caution. More information can be found in the [Seasonal Influenza Report](#).

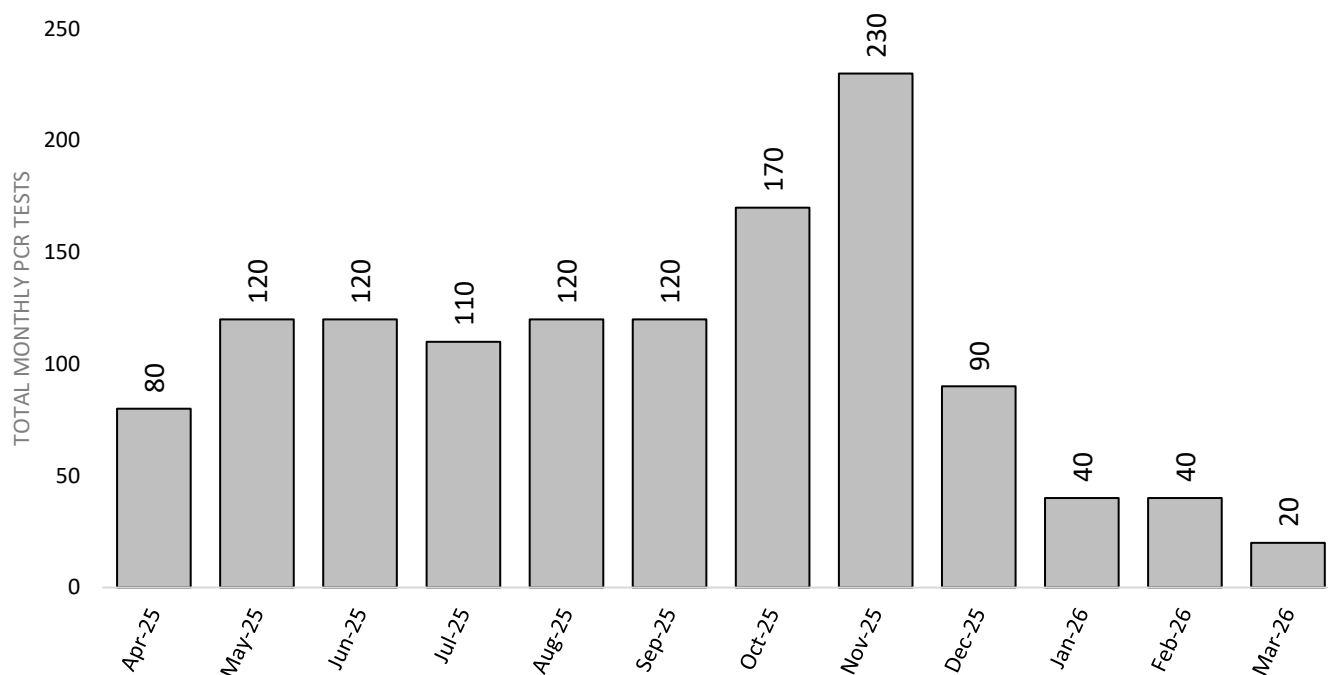
Table 1: Cumulative positive influenza A & B for the season to date

Season	2018/19	2019/20	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26
Cumulative number of Flu A & B positives up to Week 14	126	89	0	23	607	256	124	38

Table 2: Cumulative positive RSV for the season to date

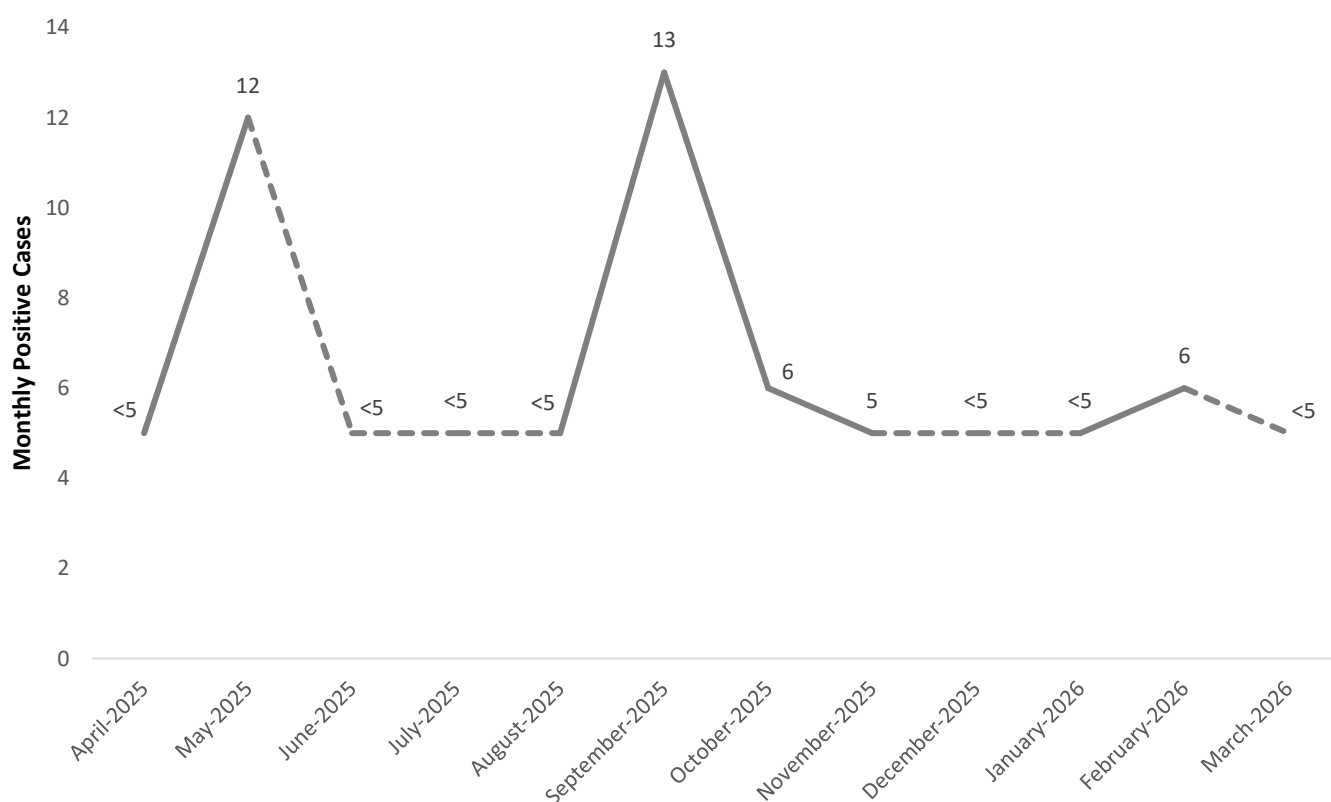
Season	2018/19	2019/20	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26
Cumulative Number of RSV positives up to Week 14	93	136	0	175	310	271	114	26

Figure 2: Monthly PCR tests* for COVID-19 in Jersey over the last 12-month period. Numbers rounded to the nearest 10²



*PCR testing for the general population, pre-admission screening and other asymptomatic screening ceased in 2023. PCR (4-in-1) tests for COVID-19 are now undertaken only when clinically required.

Figure 3: Confirmed positive COVID-19 cases by month³



² The methodology to calculate monthly PCR tests has been updated from previous reports to ensure greater accuracy. Please note that any discrepancies between the figures shown and those previously reported are due to data quality improvements.

³ Counts <5 have been suppressed to avoid the disclosure of identifiable information. A dashed line has been used in Figure 3 where suppression has been applied.